

YOUTUBE-DL

Youtube-dl is a fantastic little command line utility that lets you download videos from YouTube and a couple of other video hosting sites. Although the command line interface is off-putting at first, this tiny little app packs in quite a punch and has a host of excellent options available at a few strokes of the keyboard. We're providing a primer to get you started with it's basics along with a couple of interesting recipes.



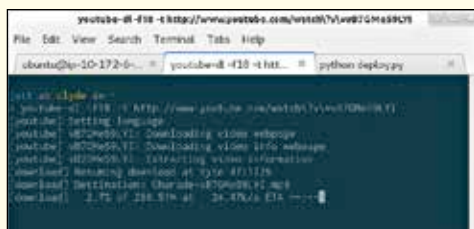
Installation

For *nix systems, the installation of the command-line utility is quite straightforward. Most of the systems come equipped with Python. Youtube-dl requires either 2.6, 2.7 or 3.3+, you can pick up the version of your choice from Python's official download page: <http://www.python.org/getit/>. Enter the following command in your terminal to get the executable.

```
sudo wget http://
youtube-dl.org/
downloads/2013.02.02/
youtube-dl -o /usr/local/
bin/youtube-dl
```

```
sudo chmod a+x /usr/
local/bin/youtube-dl
```

Installing the tool on a Windows PC is even simpler, the executable itself contains a Python runtime so you can run it directly. You can download the Windows exe from youtube-dl's download page: <http://youtube-dl.org/downloads>. You would want to add the folder containing the youtube-dl executable to the PATH environment variable so that you can access it from anywhere inside your system.



Youtube-dl in action



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Tips & Tricks has its own page numbers, and does not follow the rest of the magazine's page numbers. This is done to ensure that you can cut out and save T&T in a separate folder for later reference.

The code is updated regularly, so once you've downloaded it you can update the application anytime by using the command

```
youtube-dl -U
```



Usage

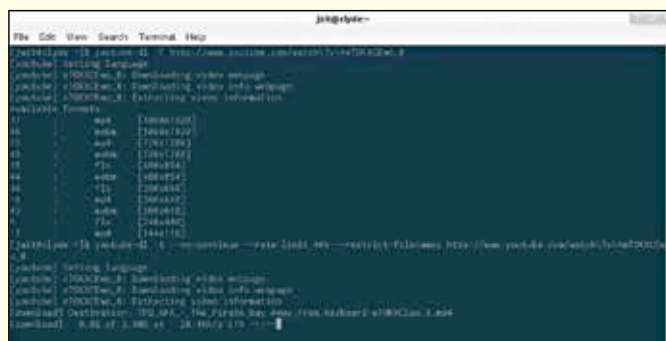
The basic usage of the program is invoking it from the command line along with options and video URL or identifier, for example:

```
youtube-dl http://
www.youtube.com/
watch?v=dQw4w9WgXcQ
```

By default it saves the downloaded videos to the same directory from which the program was called with the video id as the saved filename. You can change this behaviour by adding the `-t` option, which saves the video with title as the filename. You can also use to the `-o` option to accomplish this which also allows you to change the path of the saved files. The `-o` option also allows you

- `url`: The sequence will be replaced by the video URL.
- `uploader`: The sequence will be replaced by the nickname of the person who uploaded the video.
- `upload_date`: The sequence will be replaced by the upload date in YYYYMMDD format.
- `title`: The sequence will be replaced by the actual title of the video.
- `ext`: The sequence will be replaced by the appropriate extension (like flv or mp4).
- `epoch`: The sequence will be replaced by the Unix epoch when creating the file.
- `autonumber`: The sequence will be replaced by a five-digit number that will be increased with each download, starting at zero.

In case you want to avoid



Limiting the file download speed and selecting video quality

to define a template for the output file names, it comes in handy when storing, say, a playlist. The basic usage when downloading single files doesn't entail the use of template arguments but it may contain the special sequences that will be replaced for each downloaded video. These sequences are of the form `%(NAME)s`, Note that the 's' is compulsory.

You can replace NAME in the template sequence above with any of the ones mentioned below in any order and combination of your choice.

- `id`: The sequence will be replaced by video identifier.

using special characters or spaces in your saved file names you can add the `--restrict-filenames` option.



Video quality and subtitles

As a default, youtube-dl downloads the highest available quality video that is reported by the website, which will be either 1080p or 720p. You can use the `-F` option to list all the available quality and formats for a given video, viz. writing the following command `youtube-dl -F http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0tHqov_UHYA` prints the following: